§ 01 · STRATEGY

Priority **Actions**

The urgent week. Top investors. Critical suppliers. Regulatory watch. BSS deadline May 4.

Compiled: 2026-04-24 **From:** 9 research agents + deck rebuild + P&L model **Purpose:** One page. What to do first, second, third. What's urgent vs what's background.

🚨 URGENT — This Week

#	ACTION	DEADLINE	WHY IT MATTERS
1	**Berliner Startup Stipendium — Batch II**	**May 4, 2026**	Batch is themed **"Future of Digital Health."** €2,500/mo + workspace for 6 months. Non-dilutive. Alche is the poster-child application. Source: `research/investors-dach.md`
2	**IBB Pro FIT grant** stack	Rolling	Up to €400K non-dilutive, can stack on BSS. IBB Ventures already backed her1 — warm relationship to build.
3	**Lock Sunday Natural positioning** in pitch narrative	Before first investor meeting	CVC acquired Sunday Natural for €800M (April 2024). They're 10 years ahead but single-brand vertical. Our line: "they proved Germany; we're the multi-brand editorial play." Deck slide 8 updated.

🔥 The Five Seasons Signal

This is the most important finding of the day. Five Seasons Ventures has backed nearly every adjacent comp in Alche's universe:

COMPANY	ROUND	FIVE SEASONS ROLE
her1 (Berlin)	Series A €5.5M	Led
ARTAH (London)	Seed £2.85M oversubscribed	Led
Spacegoods (London)	Seed £2.5M	Co-invested
Puresport (London)	Seed follow-on £3.6M	Co-invested
KoRo (Berlin)	Series C €35M	Co-invested

→ **Five Seasons is the #1 warm intro target.** If you can get one conversation, the thesis is pre-sold.

Intro vector: LinkedIn → Parker Snyder (Principal, UK) or Niccolò Manzoni (Founding Partner, Paris). Warm via ARTAH or her1 founders (Rhian Stephenson / Chanyu Xu).

💰 Top 10 Investors to Contact (in order)

#	FUND	FIT	CHECK	BEST PARTNER	INTRO VECTOR	WHY FIRST
1	**Five Seasons Ventures** (Paris/London)	10/10	€500K-€2M	Niccolò Manzoni / Parker Snyder	Warm via Rhian Stephenson (ARTAH) or Chanyu Xu (her1)	Portfolio pattern match. If yes, round closes fast.
2	**Calm/Storm Ventures** (Vienna)	10/10	€50-300K	Daria Saharova	Cold-accepting; publishes email	#1 EU HealthTech by count. Wellness thesis dead-center.

#	FUND	FIT	CHECK	BEST PARTNER	INTRO VECTOR	WHY FIRST
3	**Ada Ventures** (London)	10/10	£250K-£1.5M	Check Warner / Matt Penneycard	Warm via Zinc alumni	"Healthy aging" is literal fund theme.
4	**Vorwerk Ventures** (Berlin)	9/10	€500K-€3M	Marc Rosa	Warm via HelloFresh or Everdrop founders	Consumer + health + climate thesis. DE-native.
5	**Heartcore Capital** (Berlin/Copenhagen)	9/10	€500K-€2M	Max Niederhofer	Warm via Kaia Health team	60/104 portfolio is B2C. Kaia is nearest AI-wellness comp.
6	**IBB Ventures** (Berlin)	9/10	€250K-€1.5M	Zwanet Wolkers	State-backed, open process	Backed her1 — direct Alche-thesis match.
7	**Cherry Ventures** (Berlin + London)	9/10	€500K-€3M	Sophia Bendz (content→commerce)	Cherry Pitch program	Manual (longevity DTC) in portfolio. Berlin-native.
8	**JamJar Investments** (London)	10/10 (conditional)	£250K-£1M	Richard Reed	Warm via Innocent alumni	Innocent Drinks founders' fund. Deepest UK DTC. **Check Healf conflict first.**
9	**dmg ventures** (London)	9/10	£500K-£2M	—	Cold + media pitch	Just led Equi. Offers £250K ad spend via DMG media. Unique.
10	**V3 Ventures** (London)	8/10	€250K-€1M	Lopo Champalimaud	Warm via Treatwell alumni	Lists "functional supplements" verbatim in thesis. Hidden gem.

Full fund data: `research/investors-uk.md` · `research/investors-dach.md` · `research/investors-eu.md`

🕴️ Angels That Could Close Fast

#	ANGEL	TYPE	VALUE-ADD	INTRO
1	**Fabian Foelsch** (BRAINEFFECT founder)	Operator-angel, Berlin	Schwabe Group network, dm/Budni retail, DTC supplement playbook	LinkedIn DM + warm via Berlin supplement founder circle
2	**Dan Murray-Serter** (Heights co-founder)	Operator-angel, London	Scaled Heights to £30M ARR, supplement DTC expertise	Publicly accessible, active angel (100+ deals)
3	**Suse Leifer** (Ogaenics founder)	Operator-angel, Hamburg	German certified-organic supplement expertise, uses "longevity" vocabulary in public posts	Email + LinkedIn
4	**Chanyu Xu** (her1 founder)	Founder-angel, Berlin	Direct Alche thesis backer, VfL Wolfsburg Women co-marketing	Berlin-accessible, email her1 directly
5	**Gaingels / Out Investors**	Queer LGBTQ+ syndicate	Portfolio signal for queer founders, active EU	Application-based

Full data: `research/investors-angels.md`

📦 Top 5 Suppliers to Contact (Phase 1 curated shelf)

#	BRAND	COUNTRY	HERO SKU	CONTACT	WHY FIRST
1	**Naturtreu**	Germany	Kraftreserve (Mg) + Algenkraft (Omega-3)	**Manuel Schneider (Account Manager B2B)** · b2b.naturtreu.de portal	Actively scaling retail (Feb 2026 TV campaign, Denn's rollout Aug 2025). Dedicated B2B portal. Uncomplicated path.
2	**Ogaenics**	Germany	Mrs. DO-IT-ALL (multi) + Love Your Gut	**order@novel-nutriology.com** · also on Faire	Founder Suse Leifer publicly using "longevity" vocabulary. Hamburg, premium organic. Aligned values.
3	**Puori**	Denmark	O3 Ultra Pure Fish Oil	**b2bsupport@puori.com** · existing DE distributor (Organic Friends & Sports Hamburg: Timo Lehnert)	Clean Label + IFOS + Friend of the Sea. DE logistics solved.
4	**Vivo Life**	UK	Perform Vegan Protein	**hello@vivolife.eu** · Josh Bolding founder	Only UK brand with real EU logistics (Poland 3PL, 2-3 day to DE).
5	**BRAINEFFECT**	Germany	Daily Gut Pulver (€49.90) · Sleep	`/business-partner` page · Fabian Foelsch	**Time-sensitive: pitch now before full Schwabe integration shifts channels to pharmacy-exclusive.**

Do NOT pursue Phase 1: - **Sunday Natural** — structurally DTC-only (Schweikart's "True Clean Label" philosophy). CVC-owned. Not available to curated retailers. - **Nordic Naturals, Swedish Nutra** — slower path, no EU legal entity, $2.5-5K MOQ likely. Phase 2. - **Her.one** — DTC closed-loop model; unlikely to wholesale. Could co-market instead.

Full data: `research/suppliers-nordic.md` · `research/suppliers-uk.md` · `research/suppliers-german.md`

⚠️ Three Regulatory Risks to Flag in Every Investor Conversation

#	RISK	ALCHE'S MITIGATION
1	**Ashwagandha watchlist** — BfR Communication 39/2024 + pending EU Article 8 procedure. Denmark banned, NL proposing ban.	**Launch curated shelf with zero ashwagandha SKUs.** Audit every product before listing. 3 of 5 UK candidate brands have ashwagandha exposure.
2	**BVL notification regime changes July 1, 2026** — new mandatory online form, non-EU brands need EU legal rep or Alche takes operator liability.	Budget €150-€400/SKU for notifications. Target DE+EU brands first.
3	**Grundpreis labeling enforcement** — Sunday Natural lost a Verbraucherzentrale BaWü case (Az. 102 O 89/24) over unit-price display. Regulators are active.	Display €/100g on every SKU from Day 1. Legal review before launch.

Full data: `research/regulatory-germany.md` · `research/regulatory-eu.md`

💡 Exit Comps — Use These in the Deck

Strong 2024-2026 exit proof for European longevity DTC:

COMPANY	EXIT	AMOUNT	SIGNAL FOR ALCHE
Sunday Natural	CVC Fund VIII, April 2024	**€800M** (55% stake)	PE appetite for German wellness category at scale
BRAINEFFECT	Schwabe Group, March 2025	Mid-double-digit millions	Pharma rollup of Berlin supplement brands
Bioniq	Herbalife, announced 2026	**Up to $150M** ($55M + $95M earn-out)	AI-personalized supplements get strategic exits

Add to deck slide 15 (Roadmap) and slide 22 (Why Alche) as exit benchmarks for Series A→exit path.

📋 What's Still Open

Deck: - Slide 23 (In the Wild) — placeholder until traction lands. That's intentional, but a real quote from one of the 40 beta users would make it land harder. - Slide 6 (Product Preview) — placeholder screens. Replace with actual app screenshots post-close.

Research gaps (for a later sweep): - Full 3PL quote comparison (FLEX Logistik vs byrd vs Amainvoice) for specific supplement volumes - EU Health Claims Regulation (1924/2006) deep-read for protocol-language compliance - Competitor subscription pricing map (AG1, Ritual, Feel, Heights) — what's the premium floor?

Operational: - GmbH formation (if not already UG). Worth €2-4K in fees for pitch credibility. - NDA template standardized before sharing deck with anyone. - Alche.health domain + waitlist page live (check current status).

🎯 This Week's Single Biggest Bet

Apply to Berliner Startup Stipendium Batch II by May 4, 2026.

Non-dilutive €15K + workspace + "Future of Digital Health" theme. Win rate historically ~30%. Application takes ~8 hours. The story is already written — it's the deck. Submit.

Second biggest bet: Send one email to Parker Snyder at Five Seasons Ventures this week. Pre-close, pre-meeting, pre-anything. Build the relationship before the round is hot.

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